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TITLE: Vantro Trading: Valhalla rice covers only part of the gap
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Vantro Trading: Valhalla rice covers only part of the gap

[P1] Vantro Trading said it has increased purchases of Valhalla rice for buyers in Tolan and Midgard.

[P2] The extra supply is useful but cannot replace the volume that Vanir sold on the open market before the ban.

[P3] Valhalla can raise exports by only about 30 to 35 percent on a small base, and the first extra cargoes arrived two months late.

[P4] Prices on the open-market routes are about 20 to 25 percent higher than a year earlier.

[P5] The company said it had increased its purchases from Valhalla growers and was shipping them through the usual ports.

[P6] Vantro Trading has not signed any new long-term contract with Vanir suppliers since the ban.

[P7] A company spokesperson said buyers in Tolan and Midgard were willing to pay more for quick delivery.

[P8] The company said the extra Valhalla volume was useful but could not replace the lost Vanir supply.

[P9] Vantro Trading said it would review its position when the first-quarter trade data are published.

[P10] The company said it was not buying Vanir white rice outside the exemption rules.